3.1 Introduction

Food has been a basic part of our existence. The edible parts of plants and animals termed as "food" are consumed by people to satisfy their physiological, psychological and social needs. It is universally accepted that the nutritional value of food alone does not persuade people to eat but also its colour, flavour, texture, temperature and presentation which are the other contributory factors towards food consumption patterns of the people which ensure the wholesomeness of the food in terms of quality and quantity. Thus the consumer can get a food item without compromising on the deteriorative aspects like food contamination, food borne illnesses and infections.

Food safety is an assurance that food will not cause any harm to the consumer when it is prepared and eaten according to its use. The said assurance is determined by

- Whether the harmful substances present in the food have been eliminated or reduced to acceptable level.
- Whether food that has been prepared, handled or stored under controlled and sanitary conditions in conformation with practices prescribed by government regulations.

3.2 Selection of Food

Food selection is an important step in ensuring good nutrition for the family. The daily food guide helps in deciding the kinds and amount of foods to be purchased. Selection of foods from the available variety is an important aspect of marketing. Intelligent selection of foods is based on the knowledge of attributes of high quality foods.

The types of food selection depend on:

- Availability of funds/ money
- Nutritional needs
- Effect of advertisements
- Likes and Dislikes

Availability of funds / Money

Money enhances the purchasing power and increases purchasing choices. People who have a lot of money can afford a variety of meals and can eat away from home. However, people with small incomes have a limited choice and it becomes a hard task to buy enough food to meet family needs.

Nutritional needs

Food choice will also depend on nutritional needs. Without food one becomes weak and ill. The nutritional needs of the people may vary based on age, activity, health condition, gender and specific needs during specific stage of growth and development. eg. Pregnancy, lactation.

Effects of Advertisements

Another great influence on food choice is advertisement. Advertisements have a way of persuading people to make choices. Food manufacturers and shops advertise their products through television, radio, magazines, newspapers, posters and leaflets. People tend to taste new food products that are endorsed by famous personalities.

XII Std - Home Science EM_Unit 3.indd 79 23-03-2020 3.29.39 PM